Crawling Claws

Severed Appendages with Malicious Will

Habitat: Any; **Treasure:** None

Crawling claws are severed hands that move and act of their own murderous accord. These deathless appendages can spring to life from the severed limbs of killers and villains, and sinister magic-users might animate crawling claws as foul servants. Crawling claws appear in a variety of forms, from decaying human hands to the fresh appendages of animals or monsters.

Crawling Claw

Lone crawling claws can continue killing sprees they perpetrated in life. Some recklessly attack the living, while others pursue specific victims. In rare cases, a crawling claw wreaks mayhem while the rest of its body still lives, with the original creature potentially unaware of its severed hand's crimes.

Swarm of Crawling Claws

Swarms of crawling claws are typically animated by depraved necromancers. Occasionally, these grotesque swarms arise from mass graves or after tragedies, refusing to let their murderers escape their grasp.

> Is it possible for any creature, any living being, to be inherently evil? Such an assertion may itself facilitate the committing of evil acts. By defining a person as evil, we give them free rein to behave as they will, absolving them from the wickedness of their words and the evil of their hands.
>
> —Ansolm Haas, *The Isolation of Evil*

Crawling Claw

Tiny Undead, Neutral Evil

AC 12 **Initiative** +2 (12)
HP 2 (1d4)
Speed 20 ft., Climb 20 ft.

		MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE
Str	13	+1	+1	**Dex**	14	+2	+2	**Con**	11	+0	+0
Int	5	−3	−3	**Wis**	10	+0	+0	**Cha**	4	−3	−3

Immunities Necrotic, Poison; Charmed, Exhaustion, Frightened, Incapacitated, Poisoned
Senses Blindsight 30 ft.; Passive Perception 10
Languages Understands Common but can't speak
CR 0 (XP 10; PB +2)

Actions

Slam. *Melee Attack Roll:* +3; reach 5 ft. *Hit:* 2 Necrotic damage.

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Swarm of Crawling Claws

Medium Swarm of Tiny Undead, Neutral Evil

AC 12 **Initiative** +2 (12)
HP 49 (11d8)
Speed 30 ft., Climb 30 ft.

		MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE
Str	14	+2	+2	**Dex**	14	+2	+2	**Con**	11	+0	+0
Int	5	−3	−3	**Wis**	10	+0	+0	**Cha**	4	−3	−3

Resistances Bludgeoning, Piercing, Slashing
Immunities Necrotic, Poison; Charmed, Exhaustion, Frightened, Grappled, Incapacitated, Paralyzed, Petrified, Poisoned, Prone, Restrained, Stunned
Senses Blindsight 30 ft.; Passive Perception 10
Languages Understands Common but can't speak
CR 3 (XP 700; PB +2)

Traits

Swarm. The swarm can occupy another creature's space and vice versa, and the swarm can move through any opening large enough for a Tiny creature. The swarm can't regain Hit Points or gain Temporary Hit Points.

Actions

Swarm of Grasping Hands. *Melee Attack Roll:* +4, reach 5 ft. *Hit:* 20 (4d8 + 2) Necrotic damage, or 11 (2d8 + 2) Necrotic damage if the swarm is Bloodied. If the target is a Medium or smaller creature, it has the Prone condition.